

B&C MCKEOWN

FITTING GUIDE

COMPOSITE FENCE INSTALLATION

How to set the posts, build each bay and finish off a slot-in composite (WPC) fence, step by step.

1.8 × 1.8 m	80 × 80 mm	No painting
bays (6 ft × 6 ft)	posts, 2.4 m long	or staining needed

Questions? Give us a ring.

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BEFORE YOU START

Read the guide through once before you dig. Getting the posts in the right place is the part that matters most — the boards slot in easily once the posts are right.

IN EACH BAY

- 1 × post, 80 × 80 mm, 2.4 m long
- 1 × post cap
- Composite fence boards (tongue & groove)
- 1 × top rail and 1 × bottom rail
- Post side covers
- Angle brackets and screws

Each bay comes with one post, so a straight run needs **one extra end post** to finish it off.

TOOLS

- Spade or post-hole digger
- String line and pegs
- Tape measure
- Spirit level (1.2 m or longer is best)
- Drill / driver
- Rubber mallet
- Fine-tooth saw (only if cutting boards)

YOU WILL ALSO NEED

- Concrete or postcrete for each post
- Gravel for the bottom of each hole

KEY MEASUREMENTS

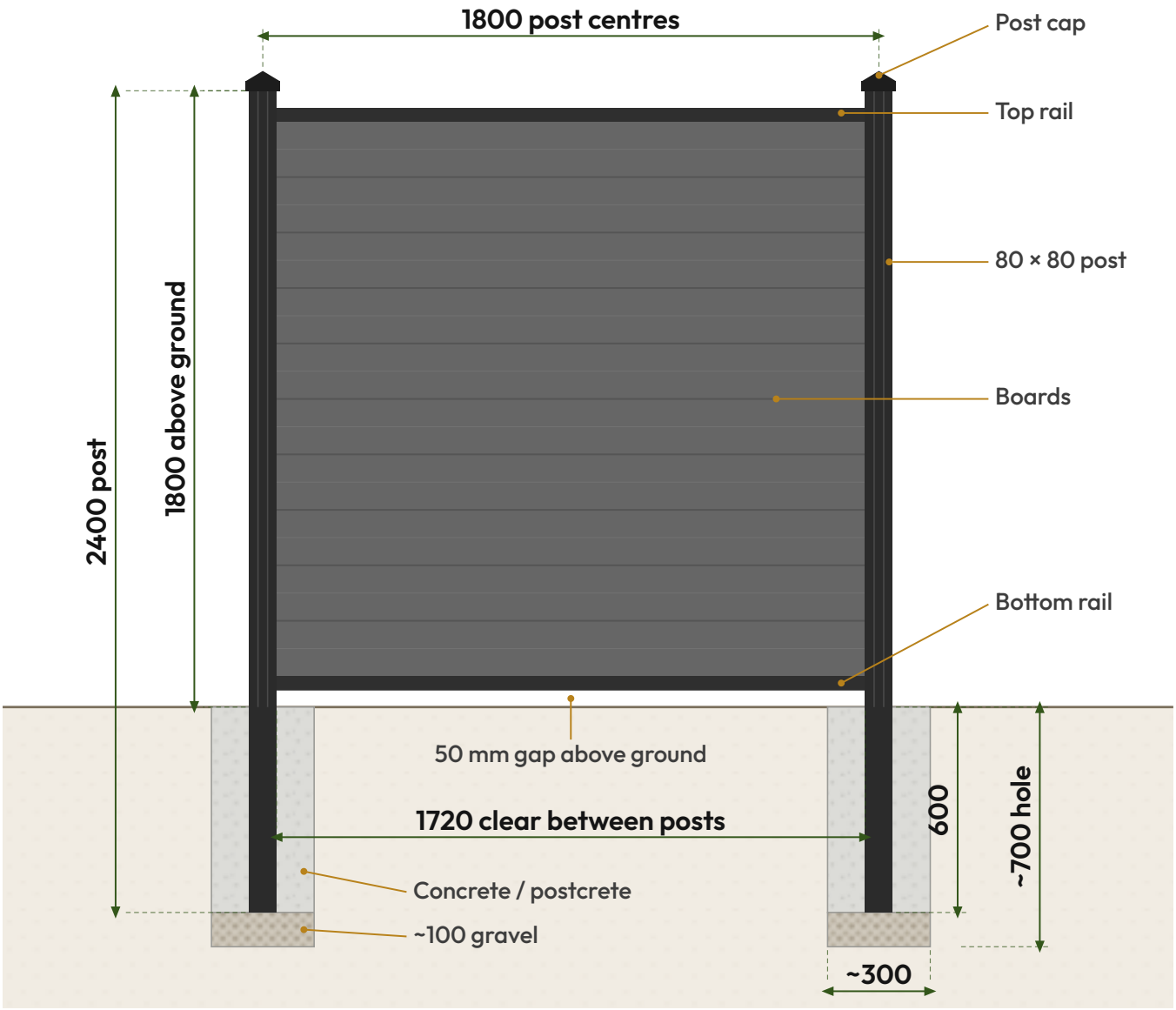
Post centre to post centre	**1800 mm**
Clear gap between posts	**1720 mm**
Board length	**1760 mm**
Post size	**80 × 80 mm**
Post length	**2400 mm**
Post height above ground	**1800 mm**
Post hole depth	**approx. 700 mm**
Gap under bottom rail	**approx. 50 mm**

Check before you dig. Make sure there are no underground pipes, cables or drains along the fence line, and that you are building on the right side of the boundary.

Stay safe. Wear gloves when handling concrete, and eye protection and a dust mask if you cut any boards.

ONE BAY, FRONT VIEW

All measurements in millimetres. The boards are 1760 mm long, so 20 mm of each board sits inside the post channel on either side.



Why the 50 mm gap?

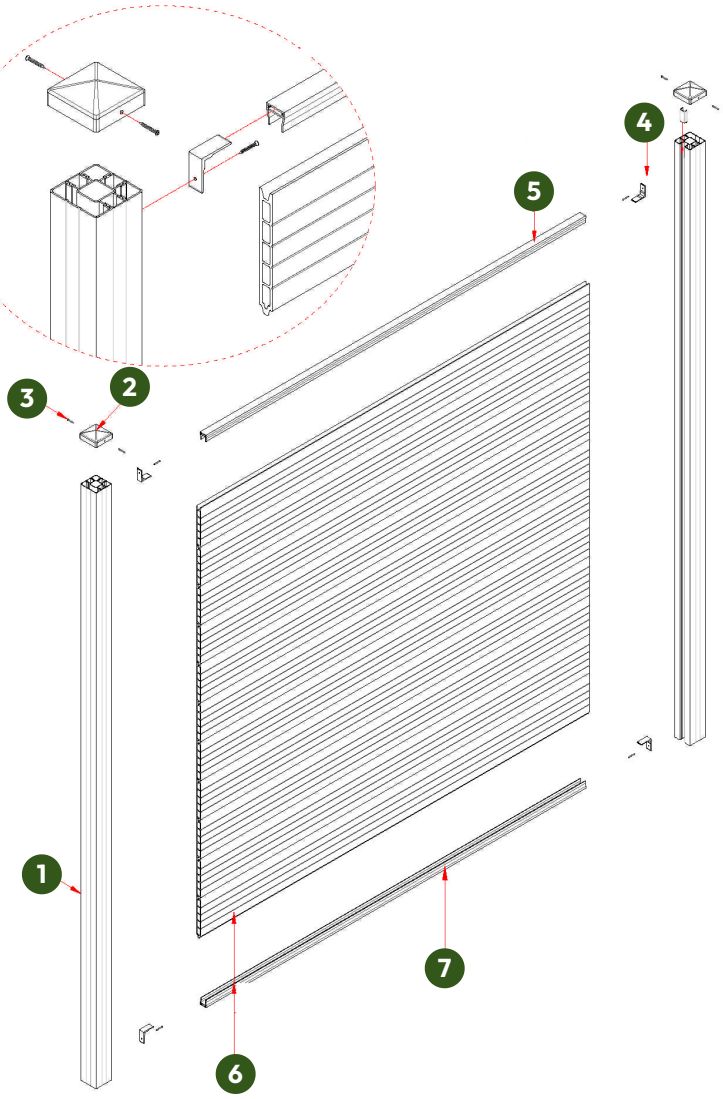
Keeping the bottom rail about 50 mm off the ground stops the boards sitting in wet ground and lets wind pass under the fence, which takes strain off the posts.

Post depth

Dig about 700 mm deep and put roughly 100 mm of gravel in the bottom. The 2.4 m post then sits about 600 mm into the concrete with 1800 mm standing above ground.

HOW IT GOES TOGETHER

The boards drop down between the posts, held in by a rail at the top and bottom. Angle brackets inside the post channels hold the rails in place.



1. **Post**
   80 × 80 mm, with channels on each side for the boards.
2. **Post cap**
   Fits over the top of the post.
3. **Screws**
   Fix the cap to the post through its sides.
4. **Angle brackets**
   Screw inside the post channel, top and bottom, to hold the rails.
5. **Top rail**
   Clips over the top board to finish the panel.
6. **Fence boards**
   Tongue & groove — each board locks into the one below.
7. **Bottom rail**
   Sits on the bottom brackets, about 50 mm off the ground.

PART A

SETTING THE POSTS

Take your time here. If the posts are the right distance apart, upright and level, the rest of the job is quick.

1

Mark out the line

Run a string line where the fence will go. Mark the first post, then mark every 1800 mm along the line — this is post centre to post centre.

2

Dig the holes

Dig each hole about 300 × 300 mm and 700 mm deep. Put roughly 100 mm of gravel in the bottom so water can drain away from the post.

3

Set the first post

Stand the post on the gravel with its side channels facing along the fence line. Check it stands 1800 mm above ground, then check it is upright on two faces with a spirit level. Fill around it with concrete or postcrete and slope the top away from the post so rain runs off.

4

Set the next posts

Set each post so there is exactly **1720 mm clear** between it and the last one. Measure at the top and the bottom of the posts, and keep the tops level along your string line.

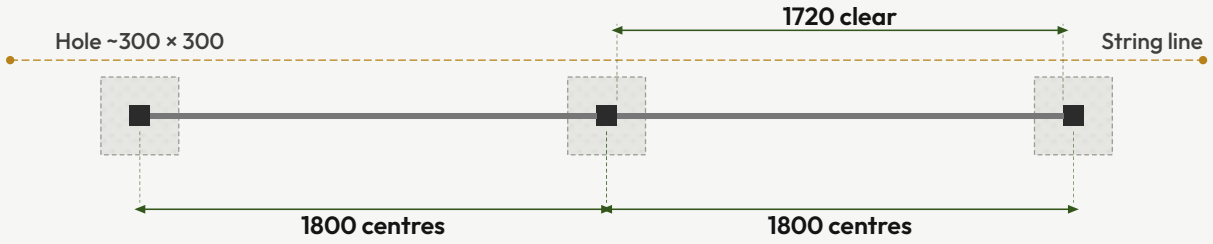
Tip: check the gap again before the concrete sets — the boards will not fit if it is too tight or too wide.

5

Let the concrete set

Leave the posts until the concrete has fully set before fitting any boards. Follow the setting time on the bag.

Plan view — looking down on the posts



PART B

BUILDING EACH BAY

6 Fit the bottom brackets

Screw an angle bracket inside the channel of each post, low down, so the bottom rail will sit about 50 mm above the ground. Check both brackets are at the same height with your level.

7 Fit the bottom rail

Slide the bottom rail down the post channels until it sits on the brackets, then fix it with the screws supplied.

8 Slide in the boards

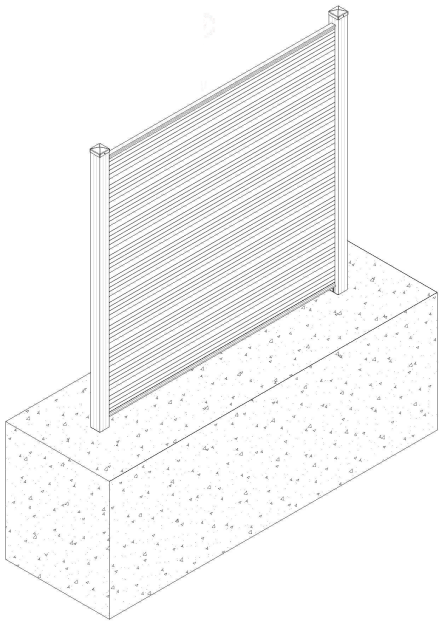
Lower the boards down the post channels one at a time, so each board locks into the tongue and groove of the one below. Tap them down gently with a rubber mallet to close any gaps.

9 Fit the top rail

Push the top rail down over the top board. Screw an angle bracket inside each post channel at the top to hold it in place.

10 Finish the posts

Fit a cap on each post and fix it with screws through the sides. Clip post side covers into any channels left open, such as on the end posts.



The finished bay

Need a shorter bay?

Boards can be cut with a fine-tooth saw. Cut the boards and rails to the clear gap between the posts plus 40 mm, so 20 mm still sits in each channel.

Looking after it

No painting, staining or treating is needed. Give it a wash with warm soapy water and a soft brush now and again to keep it looking fresh.

This guide is for general advice. Ground conditions vary, so on soft ground or very exposed sites you may need deeper or wider footings. If you are unsure about anything, ring us on 02844 615148 before you start.